

# No Room

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## CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

### SCENE 11 — NO ROOM

#### CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 10

##### **KNOCK. KNOCK.**

*The knock that ended Scene 10 continues without blackout.*

*A door opens.*

##### **JOSEPH**

Excuse me. My wife and I—

##### **INNKEEPER 1**

No room.

##### **DOOR SHUTS.**

*Joseph stares at the closed door.*

*Mary waits behind him.*

*Joseph turns and summons confidence.*

##### **JOSEPH**

There's another place.

##### **MARY**

All right.

*They move.*

### SECOND DOOR

##### **KNOCK. KNOCK.**

*A tired Innkeeper opens. Behind them, people are already packed into every usable space.*

##### **JOSEPH**

Please. We've traveled from Nazareth.

##### **INNKEEPER 2**

I'm sorry. We're full.

**JOSEPH**

Even a corner?

*The Innkeeper looks toward Mary and genuinely wishes the answer were different.*

**INNKEEPER 2**

I already have families sleeping on the floor.

*Beat.*

**INNKEEPER 2**

I don't have anywhere else.

*Joseph takes that in.*

**JOSEPH**

Thank you.

*The door closes.*

**JOSEPH**

We'll find somewhere.

*Mary studies him. She hears the strain under the certainty.*

**MARY**

Joseph.

**JOSEPH**

We're fine.

**MARY**

I didn't ask.

*Beat.*

*They move.*

**THE "NO ROOM" RHYTHM**

**UNDERScore BEGINS**

*The knocking becomes part of the score.*

**KNOCK.**

**VOICE**

*No room.*

**KNOCK-KNOCK.**

**VOICE**

*Full.*

**KNOCK.**

**JOSEPH**

Please—

**SHUT.**

**VOICE**

*Sorry.*

*Joseph moves faster.*

**KNOCK-KNOCK-KNOCK.**

**JOSEPH**

My wife is—

**VOICE**

*Nothing!*

**SHUT.**

*The rhythm builds: KNOCK. NO ROOM. KNOCK. FULL. KNOCK-KNOCK. SORRY.*

*Bethlehem moves around them: travelers, children, bundles, animals, families, people searching for their own names and their own places.*

*No one is cruel by design. Everyone is already carrying something.*

*Joseph's explanations get shorter.*

**KNOCK.**

**JOSEPH**

Please.

**VOICE**

*I'm sorry.*

**SHUT.**

*Everyone seems to have somewhere to go.*

*No one has a place for them.*

*Then Mary stops.*

**MUSIC CUTS.**

**LABOR BECOMES REAL**

*Mary steadies herself. Her breathing changes.*

*Joseph turns instantly.*

**JOSEPH**

Mary?

*Mary raises one hand: wait.*

*Joseph waits.*

*She breathes through it.*

*It passes.*

**JOSEPH**

Was that—

**MARY**

I don't know.

**JOSEPH**

Is it time?

**MARY**

Maybe.

*Joseph stares at her.*

**JOSEPH**

Maybe?

**MARY**

Joseph...

*Beat.*

**MARY**

We need somewhere.

*The objective changes.*

*Joseph is no longer searching for a proper room. Only somewhere safe.*

**JOSEPH**

Stay here.

**MARY**

No.

**JOSEPH**

Mary—

**MARY**

I'm not standing alone in the middle of Bethlehem.

*Joseph catches himself.*

**JOSEPH**

All right.

*He offers his hand.*

**JOSEPH**

Together.

*Mary takes it.*

## **THE FINAL DOOR**

*Joseph reaches another door.*

**KNOCK! KNOCK! KNOCK!**

*The door opens.*

**INNKEEPER ELI**

*Yes?*

**JOSEPH**

Please.

*That is all he has for a moment.*

**JOSEPH**

My wife is having a child.

*Eli looks toward Mary.*

**JOSEPH**

We don't need a room.

*Beat.*

**JOSEPH**

A corner. A floor. Anything.

*Beat.*

**JOSEPH**

Just somewhere safe.

*Eli is genuinely pained.*

**INNKEEPER ELI**

*I have people everywhere.*

*He looks back inside.*

**INNKEEPER ELI**

*I don't even have floor left.*

*Joseph's hope empties.*

**INNKEEPER ELI**

*I'm sorry.*

*The door closes.*

*SILENCE.*

*No music. No crowd rhythm.*

*Joseph looks around Bethlehem.*

*For the first time, there is no next door in his mind.*

## **JOSEPH'S BREAKING POINT**

**JOSEPH**

I'm sorry.

**MARY**

For what?

**JOSEPH**

This.

*He gestures helplessly at everything.*

**JOSEPH**

I should've found somewhere. I should've planned better. I should have—

**MARY**

Joseph.

**JOSEPH**

I should've—

**MARY**

Stop.

*He stops.*

*Mary moves toward him as much as she comfortably can.*

**MARY**

Stay with me.

**JOSEPH**

Mary, you need somewhere safe.

**MARY**

I know.

**JOSEPH**

And I can't—

**MARY**

I didn't ask you to fix Bethlehem.

*That lands.*

**MARY**

I didn't ask you to make a room appear.

*Joseph looks at her, emptied of answers.*

**JOSEPH**

Then what am I supposed to do?

**MARY**

Stay.

*SILENCE.*

**JOSEPH**

I don't know what to do.

*Mary looks directly at him.*

**MARY**

Neither do I.

*Beat.*

**MARY**

But we're here.

*Give the moment room.*

## **ANNA MAKES ROOM**

**ANNA**

Wait.

*Joseph turns.*

*Anna, Eli's wife, has stepped out from the household. She has heard enough.*

**ANNA**

We don't have a room.

*Joseph's face falls again.*

**ANNA**

But there's a place behind the house.

**JOSEPH**

A place?

*Anna hesitates, almost embarrassed to offer it.*

**ANNA**

Where we keep the animals.

*Joseph looks at her.*

**JOSEPH**

The animals.

**ANNA**

It's covered. There's straw.

*Beat.*

**ANNA**

It's not much, but it's dry.

*Joseph looks toward Mary. This is not what he wanted for her.*

*Another contraction begins.*

*Joseph moves toward Mary, but waits for her cue.*

*Mary breathes through it.*

*Then looks at Anna.*

**MARY**

We'll take it.

**JOSEPH**

Mary—

*Mary looks at him.*

**MARY**

It's a place.

*Joseph understands the lesson before she has to repeat it.*

**JOSEPH**

All right.

*Anna nods.*

**ANNA**

Come with me.

**THE SHELTER**

*The animal shelter is revealed.*

*Do not make it beautiful yet.*

*It is rough, dim, straw-covered, practical and imperfect.*

*A feeding trough sits nearby. Animal sounds may be heard, but avoid comic animal business.*

**ANNA**

It isn't much.

**MARY**

It's enough.

*Anna hears the gratitude in that.*

*Joseph looks at the space.*

*This time his builder instinct is useful.*

**JOSEPH**

May I move this?

**ANNA**

Anything you need.

*Joseph clears straw, checks the ground, shifts a crate, tests what is stable.*

*He is not trying to transform the shelter into the house he imagined.*

*He is making this place safer for Mary.*

**JOSEPH**

Mary. This side is better.

*He notices the feeding trough.*

*Stops.*

*He looks at it.*

*Then he cleans it carefully.*

*He takes cloth from their belongings and lays it out.*

*Anna returns with water and a clean cloth.*

**ANNA**

Here.

**JOSEPH**

Thank you.

*Anna looks toward Mary.*

**ANNA**

I've helped with births before.

*Mary's relief is immediate.*

**MARY**

You have?

**ANNA**

Yes.

*Beat.*

**ANNA**

You won't be alone.

*Mary looks at her.*

**MARY**

Thank you, Anna.

*Anna begins preparing.*

*No grand speech. She simply helps.*

**THE WORLD BECOMES QUIET**

*Bethlehem's noise begins to disappear.*

*The knocking rhythm is gone.*

*Crowd movement thins.*

*The LED simplifies rather than becomes more spectacular.*

*Lighting narrows.*

*The production begins removing things.*

*Mary settles.*

*Anna prepares discreetly nearby.*

*Joseph kneels beside Mary.*

**MARY**

Joseph.

*He takes her hand.*

**JOSEPH**

I'm here.

*SILENCE.*

*That is enough.*

**STYLIZED BIRTH SEQUENCE**

*A restrained instrumental underscore begins.*

*No literal childbirth.*

*Use fabric, silhouettes, scenic masking, carefully composed bodies, and light to preserve privacy and dignity.*

*Anna assists Mary discreetly.*

*Joseph remains present without becoming the childbirth expert.*

*Do not make the star the event yet. If visible, it should emerge with extraordinary restraint.*

*The stage moves toward near-darkness.*

*The underscore falls away.*

*Then—*

## **A BABY CRIES.**

*SILENCE.*

*Everything stops.*

*Do not immediately sing.*

*Do not immediately move.*

*Do not immediately brighten the LED.*

*Give the audience several seconds to hear the child and discover the image.*

*The smallest warmth slowly reveals*

*MARY.*

*THE CHILD.*

*JOSEPH.*

*Anna remains slightly outside the central image.*

*Joseph sees the baby.*

*He cannot speak.*

*Mary looks at Joseph.*

*Then at the child.*

*After everything, they are here.*

## **THE CHILD INTO JOSEPH'S ARMS**

*Protect silence before this action.*

*Joseph remains close but does not assume.*

*Mary looks at him.*

### **MARY**

*Joseph.*

*She invites him closer.*

*Joseph comes.*

*Mary places the child into his arms.*

*Joseph receives him carefully.*

*Do not rush to dialogue.*

*The man who once said, "The child... it's not mine," now holds the child without needing to explain himself.*

*Mary watches him.*

*Joseph looks at the baby.*

*This physical action completes the emotional thought. Scene 12 can give it words.*

### **“SILENT NIGHT” TRANSITION**

*Only after the family has been allowed to exist in silence does the first musical phrase begin.*

*One soft voice begins “Silent Night.” It should emerge from the world rather than feel like a presented solo.*

*Anna may begin, or the first voice may come from offstage while Anna simply watches.*

*A second voice may join, then perhaps two or three more Bethlehem voices.*

*Do not build to full-company volume here.*

*The manger remains the emotional center.*

*The shelter itself has not transformed. What happened there has transformed its meaning.*

*As the musical transition continues, a separate pool of night slowly appears elsewhere: open field, darkness, the suggestion of shepherds.*

*Keep the manger visible simultaneously.*

*No blackout.*

**END SCENE 11 / CONTINUE INTO SCENE 12**